

Directions for questions 1 to 5: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. Even those structures considered to be of national/state or local importance in India and protected as such remain under threat from urban pressures, neglect, vandalism and, worse, demolition, only for the value of the land they stand upon.
2. Each region of our subcontinent boasts of monumental buildings and remarkable archeology.
3. India, with several millennia of history, boasts of a diverse and rich built heritage.
4. Yet, less than 15,000 monuments and heritage structures are legally protected in India—a fraction of the 600,000 protected in the UK.
5. This poor state of preservation of a large part of our national heritage is a result of the inability of those entrusted with their care and management to unlock the economic potential of these sites and demonstrate that conservation efforts can lead to meeting development objectives in a more sustainable manner.

Solution:

The paragraph is about the heritage sites in India and their state of affairs. The starter would be choice 3 talking about the history and rich heritage of India. Next would be choice 2 talking about our monuments being archaeological wonders. Choice 4 follows saying that only a small number of monuments are legally protected in India and this number is a fraction of the number of protected monuments in the UK. Choice 1 follows lamenting that even the legally protected monuments are constantly threatened by urban pressures, neglect and vandalism. Choice 5 sums up saying that this poor state of affairs is due to the inability of those concerned to unlock the economic potential of these sites. Thus 32415 is the logical sequence of the sentences for paragraph formation.

Ans : (32415)

1. For many women workers in India, the decision to seek work is often driven by necessity rather than economic opportunities.
2. Unlike its Asian peers, which saw a sharp increase in the proportion of women workers as their growth rates picked up, the Indian economy has seen the share of women in the labor force decline precisely when it has been growing the fastest.
3. Five years after India's official statistics recorded a sharp decline in the share of women in India's labor force, a new large-scale survey conducted in 2016 shows that the proportion of working women in the country has barely improved.
4. Another reason could be rising prosperity itself, research suggests.
5. One reason for the lower participation of women in the Indian labor force is the rise in enrollment rates, which has led many young women to pursue education.

Solution:

The paragraph talks about the depleting women work force in India. The starter would be choice 3 talking about a recent survey showing a sharp decline in the women work force in India. Choice 2 follows comparing this with the rising numbers in other Asian countries. Next is choice 5 talking about the first reason for this state of affairs. Choice 4 follows detailing another reason for the decline. Choice 1 sums up saying the main driving force for women seeking jobs is necessity rather than economic opportunities. Thus 32541 is the logical order of the sentences for a paragraph.

Ans : (32541)

1. Calls and an email seeking comment from China's foreign ministry outside of regular office hours weren't immediately answered.
2. That prompted a retort from Xi, according to Duterte.
3. In an unspecified meeting with Chinese President Xi Jinping, Duterte said he will drill for oil in the South China Sea, citing an international arbitration tribunal ruling upholding the Philippines' claim.
4. Duterte didn't say when and where the conversation took place.
5. Philippines President Rodrigo Duterte said China threatened to go to war after he asserted the Southeast Asian nation's sovereignty over disputed territory.

Your Answer: 34512 ✖

Correct Answer: 53241 ✔

Solution:

The paragraph is about a statement made by the President of Philippines Rodrigo Duterte, in connection with a threat from China. The starter would be choice 5 talking about this threat and the reason behind this threat. Choice 3 follows talking about the meeting between the Philippines President and the Chinese leader, with the former saying that he would drill for oil in the South China Sea citing an international arbitration. Next comes choice 2 talking about the reaction from Xi Jinping. Choice 4 follows with the ambiguity about where and when this meeting actually took place. Choice 1 sums up saying that a confirmation for this threat could not be sought from China's foreign ministry. Thus 53241 is the correct sequence of the sentences for the paragraph.

Ans : (53241)

Directions for questions 1 to 5: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. Predictably, at the Police Station she is tortured, but just when things seem to be getting out of hand a young lady proclaiming herself as her lawyer rushes in and takes charge.
2. Not because she has won the sweepstakes but because the cops come to her hovel in the busiest slum in Asia, Dharavi in Mumbai, and handcuff her.
3. The lawyer switches on her tape recorder and tells her that she can save her.
4. When Mrs Thomas wins a billion, her life does a double take.

Your Answer: 4213 ✓

Solution:

Clearly, (4) is the opening sentence since it introduces the topic. (2) extends it and hence should follow (4). 'The lawyer' in (3) cannot logically refer to anything else except 'a young lady' in (1). Hence the best sequence is 4213.
Ans : (4213)

Directions for questions 1 to 5: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. Gordon and his colleagues tested the math skills of the Biraha by asking them to line up objects to match a sample row placed before them by researchers.
2. And they performed similarly on other numerical ability tests.
3. The Biraha tribe has just three numerical words in their language to represent the quantities one, two and many.
4. They were successful with up to three items but with four to ten objects their error rate shot up.

Your Answer: 1432 ✖

Correct Answer: 3142 ✔

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Solution:

(4) appears to be an opening statement, but it has to follow a sentence, that contains 'a test' or a similar word since 'error rate' etc indicate so. (1) naturally precedes (4). The keywords 'similarly' and 'they' in (2) refer to (4). (3) cannot logically follow any sentence and hence should be the opening statement. So, the sequence is 3142.

Ans : (3142)

The _____ of his manner towards her contradicted one moment what a more _____ look had intimated the preceding one.

☒ a) ferocity . . . heightened (Your answer - ✖)

☐ b) dubiousness . . . penetrating

☐ c) reservedness . . . animated (Correct Answer - ✔)

☐ d) coolness . . . evasive

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Solution:

'Contradicted' indicates that the two blanks have antonymous words. Thus, (C) is correct.
Choice (C)

Already reeling under the burden of the \$12 billion _____ of European steel maker Corus in 2007, Tala Steel has seen its pain worsen in the current _____, with falling steel prices and a rise in the cost of raw material.

☐ a) procurement . . . boom

☐ b) forfeiture . . . meltdown

☒ c) acquisition . . . slowdown (Your answer - ✔)

☐ d) accusation . . . downturn

Directions for questions 6 to 8: There are two blanks in each of the following sentences. From the pairs of words given below each sentence, choose the pair that fills the blanks most appropriately.

While corruption, in some countries is _____, in others it is barely visible; so the idea that it can be quantified on a simple scale is appealing as it gives us the impression that an _____ aspect of behaviour can be pinned down.

- ☐ a) flagrant . . . evident
- ☐ b) imperceptible . . . evasive

☒ c) obvious . . . elusive (Your answer - ✓)

- ☐ d) unapparent . . . explicable

Directions for questions 9 and 10: In each of the following questions, the word at the top of the table is used in four different ways, A to D. Choose the option in which the usage of the word is INCORRECT or INAPPROPRIATE.

MEET

- ☐ a) He told me that the sports meet was an occasion he did not want to miss.

☒ b) We may meet with each other sometime in the future. (Your answer - ✓)

- ☐ c) They had first met each other a year back in Tokyo.
- ☐ d) I had the opportunity to meet the manager of the fortune 500 company.

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Solution:

In statement B, 'meet with' should be replaced with 'meet'. This is because 'meet with' means to meet by previous arrangement. Here, the reference is to a meeting and not 'meet with', by chance. Hence, it should be 'meet'.
Choice (B)

Directions for questions 9 and 10: In each of the following questions, the word at the top of the table is used in four different ways, A to D. Choose the option in which the usage of the word is INCORRECT or INAPPROPRIATE.

RING

☐ a) Don't forget to give me a ring, in case you are likely to be delayed.

☐ b) The management of the company announced a hefty bonus for all its employees, when the company rang in sales of \$ 200 million last year. (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ c) His version of the story seems concocted and rings hollow to me.

☒ d) They organized a grand celebration for their friends and relatives at a sea resort in Goa, to ring in the new year. (Your answer - ✗)

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Solution:

The use of the phrasal verb 'ring in' is incorrect in statement B. The correct phrasal verb to be used here is 'ring up'. To ring up sales is to make sales of a particular value.
Choice (B)

Directions for question 11: The following question presents 4 statements of which 3, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick the statement that is not part of the context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below the question.

1. Although modern women may bristle at the idea that, first, they need a man in their lives and, secondly, that they will have to be homebodies, especially cooks, to trap a partner into matrimony, the point of the aphorism is that people can be won over via the taste of the food they are served, whether by a woman or at a restaurant.
2. Yet, taste remains a matter of — well — taste since it can vary from one person to another.
3. Women have always been told that the way to a man's heart is through his stomach.
4. Unfortunately, there is no formal scientific discipline dedicated to the study of the processes involved in cooking.

Your Answer: 4 ✓

Solution:

The aphorism mentioned in 1 can refer to 'the way to a man's heart is through his stomach' in 3. Hence, the passage begins with an aphorism (statement 3), goes on to analyse its significance in the modern world (statement 1) and concludes with the remark that taste varies from person to person. So the sequence is 312. Statement 4 states that there is no scientific discipline dedicated to the study of the processes involved in cooking. This doesn't go with the passage as the passage has no reference to the 'processes' of cooking.

Ans : (4)

Directions for question 12: In the following question, there are five sentences / paragraphs. The sentence/paragraph labelled a is in its correct place. The four that follow are labelled b, c, d and e, and need to be arranged in the logical order to form a coherent paragraph/passage. From the given options, choose the most appropriate option.

- a. Beauty is the key principle, the master key in reordering our values and systems – in economics, in governments and in education.
- b. To understand beauty from many perspectives we need experts from many disciplines to share their perspectives on beauty.
- c. To understand beauty, there is much to be learnt from Nature, which is rich in beauty.
- d. Exploring how changes can be made in ecological, economic, social, technological and knowledge systems is the vision of the 'Beauty Dialogues'.
- e. This knowledge needs to be used to inform and design more beautiful human systems.

☐ a) b c e d

☒ b) d c b e (Your answer - ✖)

☐ c) c b d e

☐ d) c b e d (Correct Answer - ✔)

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Solution:

Statement a talks of the topic 'beauty'. Both b and c talk about 'understanding' it. Statement c talks of where 'beauty' is found and statement b talks about how its 'many perspectives' can be understood. Hence b follows c. e follows cb as it talks of where this (understanding) knowledge will be used and d concludes by giving a broader 'vision'. Hence c b e d.
Choice (D)

Directions for questions 13 to 15: Each of the following questions presents 5 statements of which 4, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick a statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

1. India skipped the meeting due to its sovereignty concerns over the USD 50 billion CPEC, which goes through Pakistan- occupied Kashmir.
2. While Sharif and many other leaders spoke at the inaugural ceremony, the Sri Lankan leader reportedly took part in the discussions in the round-table meeting yesterday.
3. India anyway has to play a big role "because you cannot think of a belt and road without going over and close to India."
4. Sri Lanka, which attended the just concluded Belt and Road Forum here, has backed India's concern over the Kashmir issue.
5. Srilanka has said that it will be difficult for New Delhi to accept the USD 50 billion China-Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC) as it goes through the "heart of Indian interests".

Solution:

The paragraph is about how Srilanka has backed the Indian concern over the Kashmir issue in connection with the Belt and Road Forum. The ideal starter would be choice 4 which voices the concern of Srilanka. Choice 5 comes next reiterating this concern and the reason why it will be tough for India to accept the China-Pakistan Economic Corridor. Choice 3 follows with the big role India has to play in this corridor. Choice 1 sums up giving the reason as to why India had skipped this Forum. Thus 4531 forms the logical sequence to the sentences while choice 2, talking about the speech made by the Pakistani leader Nawaz Sharif, is the odd one out.

Ans : (2)

1. Meanwhile, the United Nations has come down heavily on the military courts system in Pakistan, lack of independence of military court judges who are within military hierarchy and the practice of holding "closed trials".
2. India has gone to the International Court of Justice (ICJ), terming the sentencing of Kulbhushan Jadhav by a Pakistani military court as "premeditated murder".
3. There are reports that Jadhav was picked up by Pakistani agencies from Iran.
4. "The committee is also concerned by the very broad powers given to the army to detain people suspected of involvement in terrorist activities without charge of judicial supervision in internment centers", the UN panel said in its report.
5. The UN Committee against Torture, in its findings published last week, has expressed concerns over Pakistan government "authorizing military courts to try civilians for terrorism related offenses".

Your Answer: 2 ✖

Correct Answer: 3 ✔

Solution:

The paragraph is about India's representation at The International Court of Justice (ICJ) with regards to the Kulbhushan Jadhav case and the stringent action taken by the UN on the military courts of Pakistan. The ideal starter would be choice 2 with the simple statement that India had approached the ICJ terming the sentencing of Kulbhushan Jadhav by a Pakistani military court as 'premeditated murder'. Choice 1 follows with 'meanwhile' the action taken by the UN on the Pakistan military courts and their practice of holding 'closed trials'. Choice 5 follows since it talks about concern expressed by the UN Committee against Torture on the Pakistan military courts trying civilians for terrorism related offences. Choice 4 sums up continuing with the concern about the very broad powers given to the army to detain people suspected of terrorist activities. Thus 2154 is the logical order of the sentences while choice 3 talking about Kulbhushan Jadhav being picked up by Pakistani agencies from Iran may be later in the passage making it the odd one out.

Ans : (3)

1. She said that it fitting that we honor his (Baba Saheb Ambedkar's) legacy of fighting against social discrimination.
2. She also exhorted the nations to harness the power of digital technologies for social and financial inclusion.
3. He told the gathering that the Unique Identification System of Aadhar ID Cards in India has enabled 1.1 billion Indian residents to benefit from e-governance and e-services.
4. The Deputy Secretary General of the United Nations has urged nations to follow the example of social reformer and Dalit icon Baba Saheb Ambedkar in the fight for social justice and equality.
5. "We should use digital technologies to promote empowerment and inclusion for all people - not least, women," she said at an event conducted to mark Ambedkar's 126th birth anniversary.

Your Answer: 3 ✓

Solution:

The paragraph is about the befitting tribute paid to Baba Saheb Ambedkar by the UN Deputy Secretary General, on his 126th birth anniversary. The ideal starter would be choice 4 which has the UN official urging nations to follow the example of Baba Saheb in the fight for social justice and equality. Next comes choice 1 reiterating the legacy of Baba Saheb fighting against social discrimination. Choice 2, which mentions another suggestion made by the official is a continuation of 1. Choice 5 sums up with the need for digital technologies to promote empowerment and inclusion for all people, especially, women. Thus 4, 1, 2, 5 forms the logical sequence of sentences while choice 3 talking about Aadhar cards may be in some other context making it the odd one out.

Ans : (3)

However, it is not always that the ordinance route can be neatly explained as a cynical move to privilege political expediency over parliamentary accountability. While contending that ordinances should be issued only to meet certain exigencies and under compelling circumstances, it is equally important to understand that disruption as a parliamentary tactic plays a significant role. A dysfunctional House sometimes constitutes a compelling circumstance in itself.

- ☐ a) It is up to parties in the legislature to observe the limits of constitutional propriety and show that they have both the time and the will to enact laws.
- ☐ b) The verdict of a seven-member Bench of the Supreme Court breaks new ground in highlighting the constitutional limitations on the cavalier resort to ordinances.
- ☐ c) Both superior courts and constitutional functionaries have routinely deprecated the propensity of governments to take the ordinance route for mere political expediency.
- ☒ d) It is the combination of Opposition obstructionism and government obstinacy in not making any concessions to those across the aisle that derails legislative business and leads to ordinances. (Correct Answer - ✓)

Solution:

The paragraph explains why the government chooses the ordinance route. It may be because of political expediency or it may be because of disruption to the proceedings in the parliament. This opinion is further extended and concluded in choice 'D'. The writer says that it is because of a combination of both of them. 'A' describes the role of parties which is irrelevant here, B and C tell us about the judgments given in courts and they do not belong to the present thought process. There is a logical extension of thought only in 'D'. The right choice is (D). The other choices belong to the other paragraphs.

Choice (D)

There is an opposing group of public intellectuals that considers social justice to be of paramount importance in India. In their estimation, forests are as much cultural and social places as they are a habitat for wildlife. Forests are home to one in eight Indians, and tiger conservation has come at a terrible human cost, they are prone to exclaim, recounting several instances of injustice where tribals have been forced out of forests, uprooted from their social and cultural context, deprived of education, development and livelihoods, plunged into poverty, and remained either unwilling or unable to integrate into the mainstream.

- ☒ a) That conservation of the tiger and other wildlife should not be at the cost of the fundamental rights of our citizenry is a common refrain. (Your answer - ✓)
- ☐ b) In the last two decades or so, elected governments in India have sanctioned the cutting down of forests to build highways, flattened forests for coal and other minerals, and drowned out forests for dams, significantly devastating wildlife and forest dwellers alike.
- ☐ c) Many observers have noted that the country is now home to approximately two-thirds of the tigers in the world.
- ☐ d) These efforts usually mean increasing vigilance against poaching of tigers and their prey, expanding existing tiger reserves and notifying new tiger reserves.

The old bogey of limiting the entry of highly skilled professionals into the U.S. is back again; this time fuelled by fears that Donald Trump would set in place barriers to their entry. The Indian software services industry, dependent to a large extent on the H-1B visa which allows foreign nationals to work in the U.S., is worried that barriers to entry would increase their costs and make their operations unviable. This fear comes at a time when they are reeling under the pressure of lower margins, tardy growth in revenues and a general slowdown in business that has been characteristic of its performance since the global economic meltdown in 2009. While the move to amend U.S. legislation that allows “guest” workers to work on a temporary basis has been an existential threat for Indian companies for more than a decade, there is greater anxiety now because it comes in the wake of Trump’s bugle call to put “America first”. _____

- ☐ a) Against this background, although the immediate fears of Trump issuing an executive order to provide legal firepower to such a move have abated, the industry remains nonchalant.
- ☐ b) Robotic Process Automation, a technology that is catching the fancy of upstarts, is likely to undercut the existing mainstream model that is based on cost-plus pricing.
- ☒ c) Against this background, although the immediate fears of Trump issuing an executive order to provide legal firepower to such a move have abated, the industry remains nervous. (Your answer - ✓)

Celebrations over the ordinance to clean up the banks' bad loans mess is quickly giving way to fear. Some bankers are disappointed they didn't get yet another scheme to kick the can down the road, promoters are worried about losing their fading jewels, potential insolvency professionals are cheering and the conservatives worry the regulator is tying itself in knots.

- ^{1.} The ordinance to clean up the banks' bad loans has brought nothing but worry to the bankers, the promoters and the conservatives while the potential insolvents are happy.
- ^{2.} With bankers dreading the face-off, promoters wary of their jaded assets and the conservatives doubtful if the regulator can handle it, the ordinance for bad loans has already lost its sheen with only the potential insolvents cheering.
- ^{3.} The fading euphoria on the banks' bad loans ordinance has made the bankers wary about the inevitable face-off, the promoters worried about their fading assets, the conservatives uncertain if the regulator can handle it with only the potential insolvents cheering it.
- ^{4.} While the potential insolvency professionals are happy, the ordinance to clean up banks' bad loans has evoked a mixed response between bankers, promoters and conservatives.

Your Answer: 2 

Scientists at IIT, Madras have come up with a novel technique where e-waste can be used as a resource not only to treat waste water but also to generate electricity simultaneously, making it an important innovation to deal with the fast growing menace of such hazardous waste in the country.

- ^{1.} IIT Madras, can be proud of its scientists who have come up with a new technique to use e-waste in treating waste water and also generate electricity and additionally dealing with the menace of fast growing hazardous waste in the country.
- ^{2.} IITians at Madras have come up with a three point formula to deal with e-waste, treat waste water and generate electricity.
- ^{3.} Coming up with a novel way to deal with the fast growing menace of e-waste in the country, the IITians at Madras have used it to treat waste water and generate electricity.
- ^{4.} The growing menace of e-waste has prompted the scientists at IIT Madras to an innovation where it can be used to treat waste water and also generate electricity.

Your Answer: 1 ✖